St. Joseph's Anglo-Chinese School
Form 5 English Language
Paper 2 Writing – DSE 2022 Paper 2 (Part B): Learning from a sample script

Learning from a sample script — how a Level 5** script handles *content* and *organisation* (60-minute lesson)

60 minutes in class: *Part 1 plan the task and the content (13 min) • Part 2 read the sample and see what it does with content and organisation (32 min) • Part 3 comment, score and write (15 min). Part 4 at the end of the booklet is the homework annex — everything marked ◎ is homework.*

In class — 60 min	1. The question 3 • 2. Task analysis 4 • 3. Idea bank 4 • 4. Writing plan 2 • A. Read the script pages 8 • B. Gist 4 • Task 2 content map 7 • Task 3 content that scores 7 6 • Task 4 moves 4 • Task 5 topic sentences 3 • 3.1 comments and scores 5 • 3.2 the real marks 3 • 4. Your turn 6 • 5. Take away 1 = 60 minutes
◎ **Homework (the same booklet)**	one idea the writer did not use • Task 4b round-off • Task 6 linking words (a)–(c) • Task 7 word table • the five-pattern table and the grammar-lesson check • Task 8 • Part 3.3 the 28 slips • find three more slips

If you would rather teach this over two lessons: *Lesson A = Parts 1 and 2 (read the script, content map, the four content moves, the moves of the letter, topic sentences); Lesson B = Part 2E and Part 3 (word table, five patterns, the grammar-lesson check, Task 8, comments and scores, the 28 slips, your turn).*

TEACHER'S VERSION — every answer is written in red, in the line or table cell where a student would write it, and the ◎ items are the homework half of the booklet.

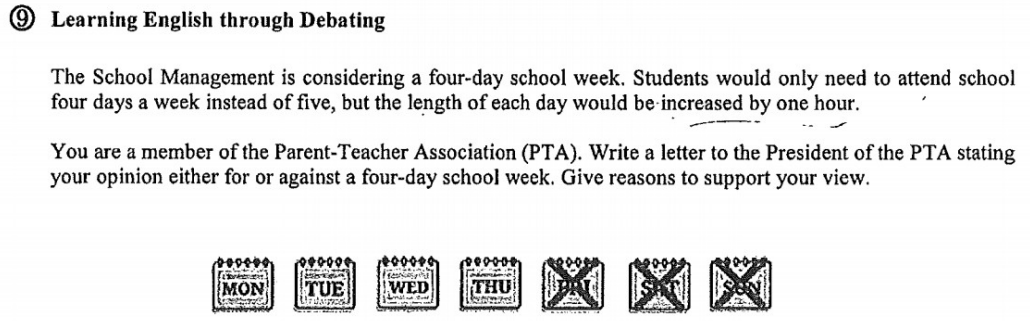
PART 1: BEFORE YOU WRITE — READ THE QUESTION AND PLAN THE CONTENT (13 minutes)

1. The question (3 min)

The School Management is considering a four-day school week. Students would only need to attend school four days a week instead of five, but the length of each day would be increased by one hour.

You are a member of the Parent-Teacher Association (PTA). Write a letter to the President of the PTA stating your opinion either for or against a four-day school week. Give reasons to support your view.

(DSE 2022 English Language Paper 2, Part B, Question 9 — 'Learning English through Debating'. Reproduced from the question paper. Part B asks for about 400 words.)



⑨ **Learning English through Debating**

The School Management is considering a four-day school week. Students would only need to attend school four days a week instead of five, but the length of each day would be increased by one hour.

You are a member of the Parent-Teacher Association (PTA). Write a letter to the President of the PTA stating your opinion either for or against a four-day school week. Give reasons to support your view.

The question as printed in the question paper.

Teaching note: *3 minutes. Ask students to find (a) the genre, (b) who they are writing to, (c) what they must state and support. The question names the reader (the President of the PTA) but not the writer — so the writer is a PTA member, a parent or a teacher, and the tone should be a concerned one.*

2. Task analysis (4 min)

Genre	Formal letter
Target audience	a letter from a member of the PTA to the President of the PTA
Purpose of writing	to state clearly whether you are for or against the four-day week, and to give reasons that support your view
Style and tone	formal, persuasive and sincere; the tone of a concerned parent or teacher
Text-type features (opening and closing)	greeting 'Dear Mr / Ms …' — no name is given in the question, so invent one (e.g. Mr Chan); state your stance in the opening; sign off 'Yours sincerely,' + your name (use 'Chris Wong' unless a name is given)
Word guide	Part B: about 400 words (Part A is the shorter task). Stay within the space given.

3. Build your idea bank (4 min)

Your letter needs to say WHO benefits and HOW. Fill in the table with as many reasons as you can, then keep the three strongest ones.

Who is affected?	Reasons FOR a four-day week	Reasons AGAINST a four-day week
Students	More time for ECAs, hobbies and rest; less exam pressure; a real weekend.	Longer days → fatigue and weaker concentration; less time for after-school activities; lunch and travel arrangements.
Teachers and other school staff	A free weekday for rest, family or professional development; less burnout.	Childcare and commuting problems; the workload is the same but the day is longer.
The school (management)	The extra hour each day can be a buffer for remedial and enhancement classes; better use of the facilities.	Timetabling and supervision become harder; school teams and clubs lose members.
Parents and family life	More time with their children; less worry about supervision.	Who looks after the children on the free day? Family routines have to change.

Note: *the answers above are one possible idea bank — any three of them, well explained, are enough for a Level 5 answer.*

4. Your writing plan (2 min)

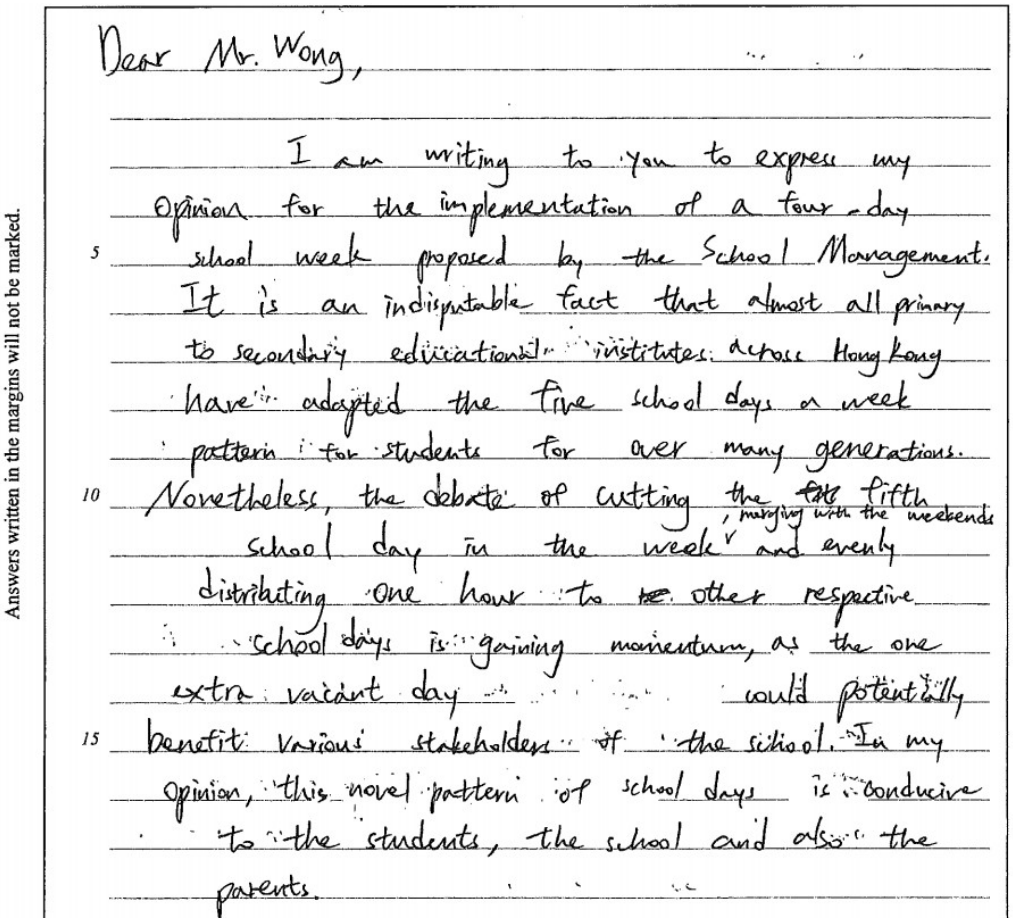
Plan your own letter before you read someone else's. One line each is enough — you will come back to this plan in Part 3.

Greeting	Dear Mr Chan,
Opening paragraph	*purpose • your stance • the three points you will cover* I am writing to support the four-day school week. In this letter I will explain how it benefits our students, our teachers and our families.
Main body	1. Students: time for interests and rest. 2. School: the extra hour can support weaker students and teachers can have a breather. 3. Parents: more time to build a closer relationship with their children.
Closing paragraph	To sum up, the four-day week benefits students, teachers and families, and I hope the PTA will support the proposal.
Closing	Yours sincerely, / Chris Wong

PART 2: READ THE SAMPLE — WHAT IT DOES WITH CONTENT AND ORGANISATION (32 minutes)

A. The sample script (Level 5) — the original pages.** *Read the seven pages of the script below, exactly as the marker read them: they are handwritten, with the writer's own corrections. Paragraph numbers in the captions — [1] to [7] — tell you which part of the letter each page shows.*

Length: 969 words in total. [2] opening 115 words • [3] 309 words • [4] 246 words • [5] 219 words • [6] closing 73 words. Part B asks for about 400 words, so this script is more than twice the guide — long paragraphs are one of its few weaknesses.



Dear Mr. Wong,

I am writing to you to express my opinion for the implementation of a four-day school week proposed by the School Management. It is an indisputable fact that almost all primary to secondary educational institutes across Hong Kong have adopted the five school days a week pattern for students for over many generations. Nonetheless, the debate of cutting the ~~the~~ fifth, merging with the weekends, school day in the week and evenly distributing one hour to ~~the~~ other respective school days is gaining momentum, as the one extra vacant day could potentially benefit various stakeholders of the school. In my opinion, this novel pattern of school days is conducive to the students, the school and also the parents.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Script page 1 of 7 — the greeting and the opening paragraph [2] (115 words)

First, students can achieve a holistic personal development with the four-day school week. The issue of learners in the school being only skilled in taking examinations and studying, while overlooking the importance of developing an interest in extra-curricular activities is always what parents are apprehensive towards. Though, this is not done by the school or parents deliberately, students often struggle to choose between using the weekends to do what they like or spend time to prepare for the next test. With Hong Kong's education system being immensely exam-oriented, affecting the future of students, many learners are left with no choice but to choose the latter. Because of this, students may lose their valuable opportunities to develop essential social skills, discover their own true interests, and create bonds between peers. So, the one extra day pattern can provide students with more time to try out different kinds of indoor and outdoor activities, from sports to creating art works to playing music. Parents can also use

Script page 2 of 7 — paragraph [3], first half (309 words in the whole paragraph)

the one extra day to apply for classes that teach the interests of their children. Since that day is already marked as vacant, students do not need to go to the classes after a tiring school day and could spend that day concentrating their beloved activities and talents. In addition, the extra one day in the weekend can give learners more freedom to meet up with their friends and spend time together, such as doing sports together or watch a movie and so much more. This can alleviate their stress from the school through socializing and doing sports. Eventually, with the lengthend weekend, students are able to acquire vital social skills, while also have a better chance to flourish with their talents and generate a stronger bond with their peers using the extra day provided. In a word, the 4 days school week can help students to achieve all-around excellence.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Script page 3 of 7 — paragraph [3], second half

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Second, schools can use the extra hour of each school day to lay down plans for students, which can help them achieve academic excellence. Without a doubt, the education system in Hong Kong is fully driven by exams, along with public exams like the DSE which determines the future of each learners. So, schools always splurge a large sum of money and resources on providing students with remedial classes, tutorial classes and enhancement class that are hosted by professionals teachers or paid outside the school in order to help learners to catch up with their subjects or enhance their exams' performances. Therefore, the extra one hour in the school days can let the schools to use it as a buffer for students and teachers to either set up extra classes in case the class is falling behind, or host a wide variety of enhancement class to train students for the future examinations and develop useful examination skills, building students' confidence and this is very integral to DSE students too. Moreover, the extra one day of the weekend is also one free day for the teachers and other

Script page 4 of 7 — paragraph [4], first half (246 words in the whole paragraph)

employers of the school. They could also use ~~the~~ the extra day to ~~re~~ relieve the stress from work ~~the~~ by doing what they like and take a breather. In short, the four day school week can shoulder the responsibility of the school from catching up with the ~~the~~ progress, help the students who are in dire need and ~~achieve~~ boost their performance, and also give teachers ~~a~~ more time to relax.

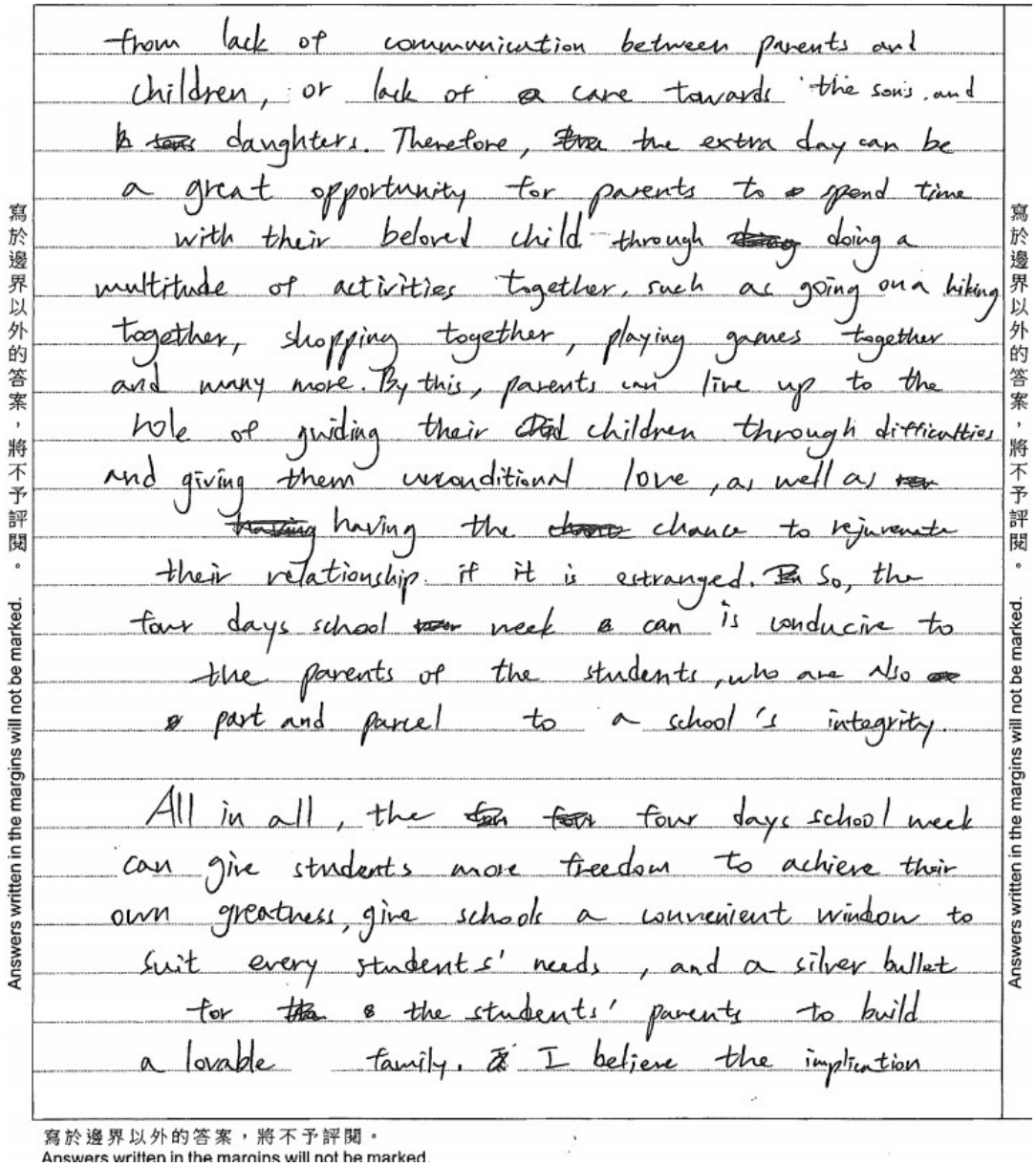
Third, the extra day can foster a healthy relationship between the parents and ~~their~~ their child. The usual 5 days school week, with about 8 - 9 hours of mandatory ~~&~~ lesson time each means parents can spend the day working without the need to worry about the ir children as ~~the~~ they are ~~to~~ ~~being~~ under schools' supervision. However, that also mean after an ~~time~~ exhausting day of work for parents, sometimes' parent return home at midnight in which even the dinner is handled by children themselves or their home maid. This comes down to both not having motivation to spend time ~~to~~ doing activities together. To add a insult to injury, ~~relation~~ ~~family~~ family issues are often stemmed

END OF PAPER

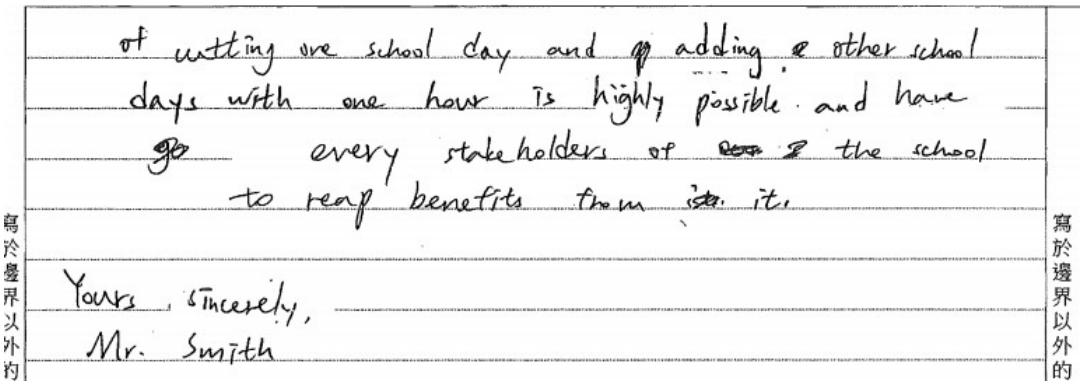
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Script page 5 of 7 — the end of [4] and the start of [5]



Script page 6 of 7 — the end of [5] and the start of [6] (73 words)



Script page 7 of 7 — the end of [6] and the sign-off [7]

Teaching note on the script pages: *these are the pages your deck walks through, kept as the original cropped images so students see the real handwriting, the crossings-out and the marker's ticks. A typed transcript of the whole script is in the appendix at the end of this teacher's copy, for checking answers and for reading the script aloud.*

B. Read for the gist (4 min)

1. Who is writing, and to whom?

2. Is the writer FOR or AGAINST the proposal? Write down the sentence that tells you.

3. One sentence each: what does paragraph [3] say students gain? What does paragraph [4] say the school gains? What does paragraph [5] say parents gain?

1. A member of the PTA (a parent or teacher, signing as 'Mr. Smith') is writing to the President of the PTA, Mr Wong.

2. FOR. 'In my opinion, this novel pattern of school days is conducive to the students, the school and also the parents.' (also 'the one extra valid day would potentially benefit various stakeholders of the school').

3. [3] students gain a holistic personal development — time for interests, ECAs, social skills and rest. [4] the school gains academic excellence and teachers gain time to relax. [5] parents gain family time and a closer relationship with their children.

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C. CONTENT — which ideas, and how are they made convincing?

Task 2 (7 min). Complete the content map for the three body paragraphs. As you work, tick the ideas in your Part 1 idea bank that the writer also used.

Key to the idea-bank tick (and the ◎ homework task): *he used five ideas — more time for interests and ECAs; less exam pressure; academic support (the extra hour for remedial and enhancement classes); teachers' rest; more family time. Ideas he did NOT use, for the homework: the cost of keeping the school open for a longer day, the effect on school bus and lunch arrangements, or the difficulty of arranging ECAs in a longer day.*

Paragraph	**Who benefits**	**The writer's main point (one sentence)**	**What supports the point (an explanation of WHY it happens / a concrete example or comparison / a factual detail about Hong Kong / a reference to the other side)**
[3]	Students	A four-day week lets students develop holistically — time for interests, ECAs, social skills and rest — instead of spending every weekend preparing for tests.	Explains WHY (an exam-oriented system leaves learners no choice); concrete examples (sports, art, music, a film, interest classes); admits the other side ('Though this is not done by the school or parents deliberately …').
[4]	The school and its teachers	The extra hour each day can support weaker students and train exam skills, while teachers gain a	Hong Kong factual detail (the DSE, paid remedial / tutorial / enhancement classes, money and

		breather.	resources); explains WHY; the counter-case that the normal five-day week acts as free supervision.
[5]	Parents and family life	The free day creates time for families and can repair a relationship that has become distant.	A concrete comparison (8–9-hour days, parents home at midnight, the dinner already finished, the maid); looks at the other side ('However, that also means …'); examples (hiking, shopping, games); a strong round-off sentence.

Task 3 (6 min). Content that scores 7. The writer does four things. Find and copy the evidence for each one from the sample.

What the writer does	**Evidence from the sample (copy the words)**
(a) Answers the whole question: states an opinion AND gives reasons	*[2] 'I am writing to you to express my opinion for the implementation of a four-day school week' + [3]–[5] each give reasons*
(b) Explains the cause, not just the benefit	*[3] 'Though this is not done by the school or parents deliberately, students often struggle to choose …' / 'With Hong Kong's education system being immensely exam-oriented … many learners are left with no choice but to choose the latter.'*
(c) Uses concrete, Hong Kong-specific detail	*[4] 'remedial classes, tutorial classes and enhancement classes that are hosted by professionals outside the school'; 'public exams like the DSE'; [5] 'parents return home at midnight in which even the dinner is finished by children themselves or their maid'*
(d) Shows he knows the other side, then answers it	*[3] 'Though this is not done by the school or parents deliberately …'; [5] 'However, that also means after exhausting day of work for parents …'*

Why does (d) — answering the other side — matter to the marker?

It shows the writer can see the issue from more than one side, so the argument sounds balanced and mature instead of one-sided. HKEAA's 2022 briefing on this question says a letter 'may present rebuttals to his/her argument and refute them' — not compulsory, but it adds interest and weight.

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D. ORGANISATION — how the sample is built

Task 4 (4 min). Label every move in the letter. Choose from the move bank and write the move in the last column.

Move bank: *• Greeting (salutation) • Purpose of writing + your stance • 'Road map': the three points the letter will cover • Point 1 — benefit to students • Point 2 — benefit to the school and its teachers • Point 3 — benefit to parents / family life • Summary of the three points + what the writer hopes will happen • Sign-off*

Move	Paragraph	What the writer is doing (choose from the move bank)
1	**[1]**	Greeting (salutation)
2	**[2]**	Purpose of writing + your stance (and a 'road map' of the three points)
3	**[3]**	Point 1 — benefit to students
4	**[4]**	Point 2 — benefit to the school and its teachers
5	**[5]**	Point 3 — benefit to parents / family life
6	**[6] and [7]**	Summary of the three points + what the writer hopes will happen + sign-off

Task 4b. ◎ HOMEWORK. Look at paragraphs [3], [4] and [5]. Each one ends with a sentence that repeats the point of the paragraph (a 'round-off'). Copy the round-off sentence of [4] and explain why an examiner likes it.

In short, the four day school week can shoulder the responsibility of the school from catching up with the progress, help the students who are in dire need and boost their performance, and also give teachers more time to relax.

It closes the paragraph by naming all three benefits of that paragraph (the school's progress, weaker students, teachers) in parallel form, so the marker can see the paragraph is complete and the point has been pushed home.

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Task 5 (3 min). The topic sentences

Copy the first sentence of paragraphs [3], [4] and [5] into the table, then answer the questions below.

Paragraph	Topic sentence
[3]	First, students can achieve a holistic personal development with the four-day school week.

[4]	Second, schools can use the extra hours of each school day to lay down plans for students, which can help them achieve academic excellence.
[5]	Third, the extra day can foster relationship between the parents and their child.

What do all three topic sentences have in common? *(Think: how does each one begin? Whose benefit does each one promise?)*

Each one begins with a sequencing linker (First / Second / Third) and then names WHO benefits and WHAT they gain — one paragraph, one stakeholder, one benefit. That is why the letter reads as organised.

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Which sentence in the closing paragraph 'mirrors' the three topic sentences? Copy it.

All in all, the four days school week can give students more freedom to achieve their own greatness, give school a convenient window to suit every student's needs, and a silver bullet for the students' parents to build a lovable family. The same three stakeholders in the same order (students → school → parents).

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Task 6. ◎ HOMEWORK — Linking words: where they are, and how to improve them

(a) Find every sentence that begins with a linking word and put the linking word into the right box.

Adding more	Sequencing	Contrasting	Cause and effect	Summarising
In addition, Moreover	First, Second, Third	Nonetheless, However, Though	Therefore, Because of this, So, Eventually	In a word, In short, All in all

(b) Your marker's comment on this script was 'mainly sentence-initial linking words'. Rewrite each sentence so that the linking word moves inside the sentence. The first one is done for you.

Sentence with a sentence-initial linker	Your rewrite
Therefore, students will be able to develop their own talents.	*Students will therefore be able to develop their own talents.*
However, parents will find it hard to spend time with their children.	Parents will, however, find it hard to spend time with their children. (or: While parents will find it hard to spend time with their children, they can still arrange activities at the weekend.) (33 words)
In addition, teachers can use the free day for professional development.	Teachers can, in addition, use the free day for professional development. (or: Teachers can also use the free day for professional

	development.) (22 words)

(c) One more organisation fault to notice: paragraph [3] is 309 words long — the longest paragraph in the letter. Where would you split it into two paragraphs, and why?

A natural split is after '… create bonds between peers.' — the first half is about what students LOSE (the problem), the second half about what the free day GIVES them (the solution). Splitting long body paragraphs is a cheap organisation mark: one paragraph, one idea.

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PART 3: COMMENT, SCORE AND WRITE (15 minutes)

1. Your comments and scores on the sample (5 min)

Tick the criteria you can prove from the text, and write the evidence in the last column.

Criterion	What to look for	Evidence from the sample	Score
Content:	All task requirements fulfilled / Good arguments / Good elaboration	Every requirement is met: the opinion is stated in [2] and each of [3]–[5] gives a reason. Elaboration is detailed and Hong Kong-specific — the exam-oriented system in [3], the paid remedial and enhancement classes in [4], the midnight dinner in [5].	**7**
Language:	Accurate grammar / Good variety of vocabulary & structures / Right style and formality	Ambitious vocabulary ('conducive to', 'a silver bullet', 'in dire need') and five advanced patterns, right style and formality for a letter to the PTA President — but the script still contains 28 small slips (see section 3).	**6**
Organisation:	Good flow of ideas / Good paragraphing / Coherent opening & closing paragraphs	Opening paragraph gives the stance and a road map; one paragraph per stakeholder ([3] students, [4] school, [5] parents); the closing mirrors the same three points in	**6**

		the same order. But the body paragraphs are 309, 246 and 219 words — over-long — and the linking words are almost all sentence-initial.	

(The scores in red are the final marks from the marker's report — see section 2.)

2. The real marks (3 min)

Three markers marked this script. Their marks:

Criterion	Marker 1	Marker 2	Third marker	Final (out of 7)
Content	7	6	7	7
Language	7	5	6	6
Organisation	6	5	6	6
Total				18.3 / 21 (≈ 87% → Level 5**)

Discussion: Which two criteria carried this script to a 5**? Where do you think marks were lost?

Content and Organisation carried the script — 14 of the 21 marks. Marks were lost in Language: the ambitious vocabulary and patterns are there, but the slips are frequent.

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3. ◎ HOMEWORK — Even a 5** script is not perfect

This writer made **28 small slips** in the whole script — we counted them, and they are listed in your teacher's copy. Five of them are printed below: correct them.

Line from the sample	Your correction
the five school days a week pattern	the five-day school week pattern (use a compound adjective before a noun)
the four days school week is conducive to the parents of the students …	the four-day school week is conducive to the parents of the students …
students are able to acquire vital social skills while have a better chance to flourish their talents …	students are able to acquire vital social skills while having a better chance to flourish their talents … (after 'while', use the –ing form)
Third, the extra day can foster relationship between the parents and their child.	Third, the extra day can foster a closer relationship between parents and their child. (a/an + adjective + singular noun)
the extra one day of the weekend is also one free day for the teachers and other employers of the school	the extra one day of the weekend is also a free day for the teachers and other employees of the school (a 'free day', not 'one free day'; employees = staff, employers = the people who pay them)

All 28 slips we counted. *A tilde (~) marks the arguable ones (register or collocation rather than grammar) — drop them if you want a smaller number. The five items above are marked ★. The name in [1] and [7] is not counted: the question asks candidates to invent a name for the President, so 'Mr Wong' is fine, and the paper says candidates should write 'Chris Wong' if they name themselves.*

#	¶	The slip	The correction
1	**[2]**	my opinion for the implementation of a four-day school week	my opinion on the implementation … (preposition)
2	**[2]**	the five school days a week pattern	the five-day school week pattern
3	**[2]**	for students for over many generations	for students for many generations (or 'over many generations' — not both)
4	**[2]**	the debate of cutting the fifth school day	the debate over cutting the fifth school day
5	**[2]**	merging with the weekends distributing one hour to the other respective school days	merging the weekend with the school days and assigning one extra hour to each of them (the phrase has no finite verb)
6	**[3]**	what parents are apprehensive towards	what parents are apprehensive about
7	**[3]**	to do what they like or spend time to prepare for the next test	to do what they like or spending time preparing for the next test (parallel form)
8	**[3]**	such as watch a movie and so much more	such as watching a movie and much more
9	**[3]**	through socializing and doing sports	through socializing and playing sports ~ (collocation)
10	**[3]**	a better chance to flourish their talents	a better chance to let their talents flourish / to develop their talents ~ ('flourish' is not transitive)
11	**[3]**	the four days school week	the four-day school week (the same slip recurs in [5] and [6] — counted once)
12	**[4]**	public exams like the DSE which determines the future of each learner	public exams like the DSE which determine the future of each learner (agreement: 'exams … determine')
13	**[4]**	schools always splurge a larger sum of money and resources on providing …	schools always spend a great deal of money and resources on providing … ~ ('splurge' is too informal for this reader; money is uncountable)
14	**[4]**	the extra one hour in the school days	the extra hour in each school day

15	**[4]**	to either set extra classes in case the class is falling behind	to either set extra classes in case the class falls behind (tense after 'in case')
16	**[4]**	building students' confidence and this is very integral to students too	building students' confidence, which is very important for students as well (comma splice)
17	**[4]**	is also one free day for the teachers	is also a free day for the teachers ~ (article)
18	**[4]**	the teachers and other employers of the school	the teachers and other employees of the school (employees = staff)
19	**[4]**	shoulder the responsibility of the school from catching up with the progress	take on the school's responsibility for catching up with the syllabus
20	**[5]**	can foster relationship between the parents and their child	can foster a closer relationship between parents and their child
21	**[5]**	with about 8-9 hours of mandatory lesson time each means parents can spend the day working	with about 8-9 hours of mandatory lesson time each day, which means that parents can spend the day working
22	**[5]**	after exhausting day of work for parents	after an exhausting day at work
23	**[5]**	This comes down to both not having sufficient time to spend doing activities together	This comes down to both sides not having enough time to spend on activities together (unclear)
24	**[5]**	family issues are often stemmed from lack of communication	family issues often stem from a lack of communication (no passive)
25	**[5]**	such as going on a hiking together	such as going hiking together
26	**[5]**	who are also a part and parcel to a school's integrity	who are part and parcel of the school community
27	**[6]**	give school a convenient window to suit every student's needs	give the school a convenient window to suit every student's needs
28	**[6]**	and have every stakeholder of the school to reap benefits from it	and that every stakeholder of the school will reap benefits from it (clause, not infinitive)

4. Your turn (6 min)

Write the opening paragraph of your own letter (4–5 sentences, about 50 words). Use the plan you made in Part 1.

Greeting • I am writing to … (say what you are writing about) • your stance • tell the reader the three points you will cover

Use at least one pattern or word from the 'steal these' table.

Dear Mr Chan, / I am writing to express my strong support for the School Management's proposal of a four-day school week. As a parent, I believe the extra day would benefit our children, our teachers and the whole school community, and I would like to explain why. (47 words)

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5. What to take away (1 min)

Content, Language and Organisation are 7 marks each in Part B. This script used its **ideas** and the **way they were arranged** to reach a 5** — 14 of its 21 marks — even though it still contains 28 small slips. Great writers at Level 5** make sure that (1) every requirement in the question is answered, (2) every reason is explained, not just listed, and (3) the reader always knows which point belongs to which paragraph.

PART 4 (◎ HOMEWORK): LANGUAGE — WORDS AND SENTENCE PATTERNS

Task 7. ◎ HOMEWORK — Read each word or phrase and study how the writer uses it in the sample sentence.

Word / phrase	What it means	The sentence in the sample
indisputable	cannot be argued against; certain	It is an indisputable fact that almost all primary to secondary educational institutions across Hong Kong have adopted…
gaining momentum	becoming stronger / more widely supported	the debate of cutting the fifth school day in the week … is gaining momentum
stakeholders	the people who are involved and affected	the one extra valid day would potentially benefit various stakeholders of the school
conducive to	helpful to / good for	this novel pattern of school days is conducive to the students, the school and also the parents
alleviate	make (pain or stress) less severe	This can alleviate their stress from school through socializing and doing sports.
integral	very important (to something)	building students' confidence and this is very integral to

		students too
in dire need	needing help very much	help the students who are in dire need
splurge (on)	spend a lot of money (on)	schools always splurge a larger sum of money and resources on providing students with…
live up to the role of	do what the role expects of you	parents can live up to the role of guiding their children through difficulties
part and parcel of	an essential part of	parents … are also a part and parcel to a school's integrity
a silver bullet	a simple, instant solution to a problem	and a silver bullet for the students' parents to build a lovable family
reap benefits	gain advantages	every stakeholder of the school (can) reap benefits from it

◎ **HOMEWORK — Five advanced sentence patterns used in this script.** The pattern in each sentence is in **bold**. These are the structures that make a script read like a top script — learn one or two and use them in your own writing.

Pattern	**The writer's sentence (pattern in bold)**	**Why it earns marks**
1. It is + adjective + that-clause (impersonal opener that states the background as fact)	It is **an indisputable fact** that almost all primary to secondary educational institutions across Hong Kong have adopted the five school days a week pattern for students for over many generations.	Opens the letter with a confident, formal sentence and establishes the background in one move — the job Lesson 1 Pattern 1 / Pattern 4 does.
2. With + noun + -ing participle phrase (fronted cause)	**With Hong Kong's education system being immensely exam-oriented, affecting the future of students**, many learners are left with no choice but to choose the latter.	Packs the whole cause into one phrase before the main clause, so the reader sees the reason first. Same mechanism as Lesson 1 Pattern 2.
3. Relative clause (which / that / who) (adding information to a noun)	Second, schools can use the extra hours of each school day to lay down plans for students, **which can help them achieve academic excellence**.	Attaches the benefit to the idea in the same sentence, so the argument flows instead of stopping. Taught in F.5 and used again here.
4. -ing participle clause (result or by-product)	Eventually, with the lengthened weekend, students are able to acquire vital social skills **while having a better chance to flourish their talents** and generate a stronger bond with their peers **using the extra day provided**.	Two ideas in one sentence with no linking word — the mark of a script that reads as controlled rather than simple.

5. Long noun-phrase subject + 'what …' clause	**The issue of learners in the school being only skilled in taking examinations and studying while overlooking the importance of developing an interest in other extra-curricular activities** is always **what parents are apprehensive towards**.	The subject itself carries the argument, so the sentence sounds mature and academic. (Careful: do not overdo it — this one is hard to read.)

Not in this script — one to add yourself: *One pattern this writer did NOT use — inversion, which puts the adverb first to make the sentence emphatic: Not only CAN the extra day reduce students' stress, but it CAN ALSO give them time to develop their talents. Rarely DO schools have the chance to rethink their timetable like this.*

Did this script use the patterns from our grammar lessons? The five tables above are the advanced structures in the script; this table checks the letter against the sentence patterns you were taught — F.6 Grammar Lessons 1–3 and F.5 inversion.

Your grammar lesson	The pattern you taught	Used here?	The evidence from this script — or the upgrade to use next time
F.6 Grammar L1 — introductions	In recent years, [Topic] has become an indispensable part of daily life for [Group].	Partly	He does establish the background, but with 'It is an indisputable fact that …' rather than 'In recent years …'.
	Living in a fast-paced society, [Group] are constantly exposed to [Problem].	Yes — same mechanism	'With Hong Kong's education system being immensely exam-oriented, affecting the future of students, many learners are left with no choice but to choose the latter.'
	In recent times, the issue of [Topic] has sparked widespread concern across society.	Yes — in function	'the debate of cutting the fifth school day in the week … is gaining momentum' (same move, plainer wording).
	It is undeniable that [Topic] plays a pivotal role in shaping [Outcome].	Yes — almost word for word	'It is an indisputable fact that …' — the writer uses your Pattern 4 with a different adjective.
F.6 Grammar L2 — topic sentences	To begin with, [Topic] offers [Group] a golden opportunity to [verb phrase], paving the way for [outcome].	Same move, simpler	'First, students can achieve a holistic personal development with the four-day school week.' Right move (sequencing linker + who benefits), Level 3 wording.
	From the perspective of [Group], [Topic] allows them to [verb phrase], which in turn [further	No	But [4] does the same job unpatterened: '… use it as a buffer for students and teachers

	benefit].		to either set extra classes … or host a wide variety of enhancement classes …’
	[Topic] serves as a powerful means of [gerund], which enables [Group] to [verb phrase].	No — only the relative-clause half	He writes ‘… which can help them achieve academic excellence’. Upgrading it: ‘The extra day serves as a powerful means of developing students’ interests, which enables them to discover their own talents.’
	It is often said that [opposing view]. However, this argument overlooks the fact that [reason].	The move is there, the pattern is not	‘However, that also means after exhausting day of work for parents, sometimes parents return home at midnight …’ Upgraded: ‘It is often said that a four-day week would leave students unsupervised. However, this argument overlooks the fact that most parents return home at midnight anyway.’
F.6 Grammar L3 — solutions	There is an urgent need for [doer] to [base verb phrase].	No	His suggestions are plain ‘can’ sentences: ‘Parents can also use the one extra day to apply for classes that teach the interests of their children.’
	To [goal], [doer] should make it a priority to [base verb phrase].	No	Upgrade for this letter: ‘To help weaker students catch up, schools should make it a priority to use the extra hour for remedial classes.’
	[Doer], in collaboration with [second party], should [verb phrase].	No	Upgrade: ‘Parents, in collaboration with schools, should plan interest classes for the free day.’
F.5 Inversion (Lesson 2)	Not only + auxiliary + subject + verb, but (subject) also + verb	No	Where it would fit: ‘Not only can the extra day reduce students’ stress, but it can also give them time to develop their talents.’
	Never / Rarely / Seldom + auxiliary + subject + verb	No	Where it would fit: ‘Rarely do parents have the chance to spend a whole weekday with

			their children.’
	Only by + -ing + auxiliary + subject + verb	No	Where it would fit: ‘Only by freeing one day a week can schools give students the time to discover their own interests.’
F.5 relative clauses and participle phrases	Relative clause: which / who / that	Yes	‘which can help them achieve academic excellence’; ‘enhancement classes that are hosted by professionals outside the school’. One slip: ‘public exams like the DSE which determines …’ needs ‘determine’.
	Participle phrase (–ing / with + noun + –ing)	Yes	‘With … being …’; ‘building students’ confidence’; ‘using the extra day provided’.
	Nominalisation (the + noun + of)	Yes	‘the implementation of a four-day school week’; ‘the lack of communication between parents and children’.

Task 8. ◎ HOMEWORK — Use TWO of the five patterns above and FOUR items from the word table to write TWO sentences about the four-day school week.

It is an indisputable fact that a longer school day is conducive to weaker students. With the DSE determining the future of each learner, many of them are left with no choice but to attend tutorial classes, so the extra hour can alleviate their pressure and let them reap the benefits of a real weekend. (55 words)

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Homework / next lesson:

1. Finish the paragraph in Part 3. 2. Write the topic sentences of your three body paragraphs, using the pattern from Task 5 (sequencing word + who benefits + what they gain). 3. Find three more slips in the script and correct them (there are 28 altogether).

What HKEAA said about this question (2022 briefing for teachers):

‘Introduction — Salutation/Greeting; Stance. Body — Supporting arguments/counter-argument. Closing. The letter should provide clearly stated points that are relevant to the discussion of schools adopting a four-day week instead of five. Candidates may present rebuttals to his/her argument and refute them (not necessary to do both). Tone of a concerned parent or teacher would add more interest to the points given.’ It was also the most popular elective question in Part B in 2022 (mean 57.9%).

Design note: *your original handout had Task Analysis → Writing plan → Sample → comments/scores. The content tasks (C) and organisation tasks (D) are the new middle of the lesson; part E now carries the five advanced sentence patterns as well as the vocabulary. If 60 minutes is tight, your order of priority is Task 4 (moves) → Task 5 (topic sentences) → Task 2 (content map); Task 8 and the pattern table can go home.*

APPENDIX (teacher's copy only): typed transcript of the sample script

Best-effort transcription of the handwriting: crossed-out words are dropped and the writer's own insertions are kept, so this is close to the version the marker read — the slips counted above are kept as written. A few words are only partly legible: in [4] the phrase after 'the extra' may be a number word. Use this to check students' answers, or give it to anyone who cannot read the handwriting.

[1] Dear Mr. Wong,

[2] I am writing to you to express my opinion for the implementation of a four-day school week proposed by the School Management. It is an indisputable fact that almost all primary to secondary educational institutions across Hong Kong have adopted the five school days a week pattern for students for over many generations. Nonetheless, the debate of cutting the fifth school day in the week, merging with the weekends distributing one hour to the other respective school days is gaining momentum, as the one extra valid day would potentially benefit various stakeholders of the school. In my opinion, this novel pattern of school days is conducive to the students, the school and also the parents.

[3] First, students can achieve a holistic personal development with the four-day school week. The issue of learners in the school being only skilled in taking examinations and studying while overlooking the importance of developing an interest in other extra-curricular activities is always what parents are apprehensive towards. Though this is not done by the school or parents deliberately, students often struggle to choose between using the weekends to do what they like or spend time to prepare for the next test. With Hong Kong's education system being immensely exam-oriented, affecting the future of students, many learners are left with no choice but to choose the latter. Because of this, students may lose their valuable opportunities to develop essential social skills, discover their own true interests and create bonds between peers. So, the one extra day pattern can provide students with more time to try out different kinds of indoor and outdoor activities, from sports to creating art works to playing music. Parents can also use the one extra day to apply for classes that teach the interests of their children. Since that day is already marked as vacant, students do not need to go to the classes after a tiring school day and could spend that day concentrating on their beloved activities and talents. In addition, the extra one day in the weekend can give learners more freedom to meet up with their friends and spend time together, such as watch a movie and so much more. This can alleviate their stress from school through socializing and doing sports. Eventually, with the lengthened weekend, students are able to acquire vital social skills while having a better chance to flourish their talents and generate a stronger bond with their peers using the extra day provided. In a word, the four days school week can help students to achieve all-rounded excellence.

[4] Second, schools can use the extra hours of each school day to lay down plans for students, which can help them achieve academic excellence. Without a doubt, the education system in Hong Kong is fully driven by exams, along with public

exams like the DSE which determines the future of each learner. So, schools always splurge a larger sum of money and resources on providing students with remedial classes, tutorial classes and enhancement classes that are hosted by professionals outside the school in order to help learners catch up with their subjects or enhance their exam performance. Therefore, the extra one hour in the school days can let the schools use it as a buffer for students and teachers to either set extra classes in case the class is falling behind, or host a wide variety of enhancement classes to train students for the future examination and develop useful examination skills, building students' confidence and this is very integral to students too. Moreover, the extra one day of the weekend is also one free day for the teachers and other employers of the school. They could also use the extra day to relieve the stress from work by doing what they like and take a breather. In short, the four day school week can shoulder the responsibility of the school from catching up with the progress, help the students who are in dire need and boost their performance, and also give teachers more time to relax.

[5] Third, the extra day can foster relationship between the parents and their child. The usual 5 days school week, with about 8-9 hours of mandatory lesson time each means parents can spend the day working without the need to worry about their children as they are under schools' supervision. However, that also means after exhausting day of work for parents, sometimes parents return home at midnight in which even the dinner is finished by children themselves or their maid. This comes down to both not having sufficient time to spend doing activities together. To add insult to injury, family issues are often stemmed from lack of communication between parents and children, or lack of care towards the sons and daughters. Therefore, the extra day can be a great opportunity for parents to spend time with their beloved child through doing a multitude of activities together, such as going on a hiking together, shopping together, playing games together and many more. By this, parents can live up to the role of guiding their children through difficulties and giving them unconditional love, as well as having the chance to rejuvenate their relationship if it is estranged. So, the four days school week is conducive to the parents of the students, who are also a part and parcel to a school's integrity.

[6] All in all, the four days school week can give students more freedom to achieve their own greatness, give school a convenient window to suit every student's needs, and a silver bullet for the students' parents to build a lovable family. I believe the implication of cutting one school day and adding other school days with one hour is highly possible, and have every stakeholder of the school to reap benefits from it.

[7] Yours sincerely,
Mr. Smith